

UPSC POLITY SOLVED WORKBOOK

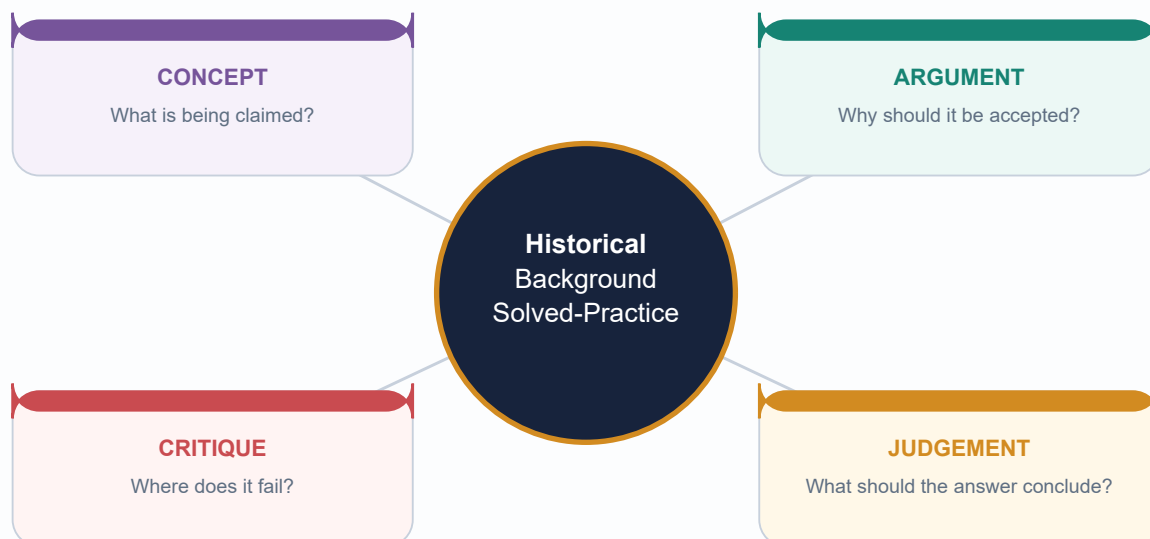
Historical Background Solved-Practice Workbook

Coverage: every major subtopic from Company Rule to constitutional transformation

16 integrated MCQs + 4 remedial MCQs

Strict answer rotation: A -> B -> C -> D

Three original Mains questions with model solutions



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Verified PYQ Audit

Prelims / GS-II
Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

No question is labelled as an exact UPSC PYQ in this package unless its wording and year are verified against an accessible official paper. The official-paper downloads available during this export returned access pages rather than valid PDFs, so unverified coaching-site attributions were deliberately excluded.

STATIC THEORY

- High-frequency PYQ domains retained as original practice: Charter Acts; title changes; 1909, 1919 and 1935 distinctions; separate versus joint electorates; operational status of the 1935 federation; Dominion versus Republic.
- This conservative treatment follows the no-fabrication rule: a plausible old question is not presented as a PYQ without primary verification.
- The workbook therefore provides fully solved original UPSC-style questions covering all relevant subtopics.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A question repeated on multiple coaching websites is automatically a verified UPSC PYQ.

CORRECT: Year, wording and options must be checked against the official paper or another traceable primary copy.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

UPSC preparation -> Source verification -> No fabricated PYQ labels

HIGH

Solved MCQs 1-4

Prelims Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Original UPSC-style practice. Correct options rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D.

STATIC THEORY

- 1. Which event most directly converted the East India Company into a territorial-fiscal power?

- A. Grant of Diwani, 1765
- B. Charter of 1600
- C. Battle of Plassey, 1757
- D. Regulating Act, 1773

- ANSWER: A - The Diwani gave revenue and civil-justice authority over Bengal, Bihar and Orissa. Plassey created political influence, but Diwani supplied the durable fiscal basis of government.

- 2. Which statement correctly distinguishes the Regulating Act, 1773 from the Charter Act, 1833?

- A. Both created the Governor-General of India
- B. The former created the Governor-General of Bengal; the latter created the Governor-General of India
- C. The former ended Company trade; the latter created the Supreme Court
- D. Both introduced open civil-service competition

- ANSWER: B - Warren Hastings became the first Governor-General of Bengal under 1773; William Bentinck became the first Governor-General of India under 1833.

- 3. Under Pitt's India Act, 1784, political supervision was primarily exercised through which institution?

- A. Council of India
- B. Secretary of State for India
- C. Board of Control
- D. Federal Court

- ANSWER: C - The Board of Control supervised political, military and revenue matters, while the Court of Directors retained commercial management.

- 4. Which sequence correctly describes the Company's commercial retreat?

- A. 1833 partial monopoly end -> 1813 full trade end -> 1853 abolition
- B. 1793 trade end -> 1813 Crown rule -> 1833 competition
- C. 1813 full trade end -> 1833 partial reopening -> 1858 monopoly
- D. 1813 partial monopoly end -> 1833 complete commercial exit -> 1858 end of Company government

- ANSWER: D - The 1813 Act retained tea and China trade; the 1833 Act ended all commercial activity; the 1858 Act ended Company government.

MEMORY HOOK

Attempt first; read the answer only after fixing the chronology and institutional distinction.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Polity -> Historical Background -> Adaptive practice

HIGH

Solved MCQs 5-8

Prelims Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Original UPSC-style practice. Correct options rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D.

STATIC THEORY

- 5. Which institutional change belongs to the Charter Act, 1853?

- A. Separation of legislative and executive functions in the Governor-General's council
- B. Separate electorate for Muslims
- C. Provincial autonomy
- D. Transfer of government to the Crown

- ANSWER: A - The 1853 Act added legislative councillors and separated legislative work from executive work. It also introduced the open-competition principle.

- 6. What was the constitutional effect of the Government of India Act, 1858?

- A. It made the Central executive responsible to the legislature
- B. It transferred Company government to the Crown and created the Secretary of State for India
- C. It created provincial dyarchy
- D. It established the All-India Federation

- ANSWER: B - The Act abolished Company rule, the Court of Directors and the Board of Control, replacing them with direct Crown administration.

- 7. The Indian Councils Act, 1892 is best associated with:

- A. Direct universal election
- B. Responsible provincial cabinets
- C. Budget discussion, questions and an indirect electoral principle
- D. Separate electorates for Muslims

- ANSWER: C - The Act enlarged councils and introduced recommendation-based indirect representation, but did not create executive responsibility.

- 8. Which proposition about the Morley-Minto reforms is correct?

- A. They introduced provincial autonomy
- B. They abolished communal representation
- C. They made the Central executive responsible
- D. They introduced separate electorates for Muslims

- ANSWER: D - The defining feature of the 1909 Act was the separate Muslim electorate. Dyarchy came in 1919 and autonomy in 1935.

MEMORY HOOK

Attempt first; read the answer only after fixing the chronology and institutional distinction.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Polity -> Historical Background -> Adaptive practice

HIGH**Solved MCQs 9-12****Prelims** Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Original UPSC-style practice. Correct options rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D.

STATIC THEORY

- 9. Why was provincial dyarchy under the 1919 Act structurally weak?
 - A. Ministers were responsible for welfare subjects but lacked control over crucial finance and coercive departments
 - B. Provinces possessed complete fiscal sovereignty
 - C. Governors were elected by provincial legislatures
 - D. All provincial subjects were transferred

- ANSWER: A - Responsibility was separated from authority: transferred ministries depended on resources and machinery controlled through reserved subjects.
- 10. Which statement about the Poona Pact is correct?
 - A. It abolished reserved representation for depressed classes
 - B. It replaced the proposed separate electorate with reserved seats in a joint electorate
 - C. It created separate Muslim electorates
 - D. It established universal adult franchise

- ANSWER: B - The Pact changed the electoral method while retaining and enlarging reserved representation.
- 11. Which feature of the Government of India Act, 1935 actually operated?
 - A. All-India Federation
 - B. Dyarchy at the Centre
 - C. Provincial autonomy
 - D. Complete provincial sovereignty

- ANSWER: C - Provincial autonomy operated from 1937. The federation and central dyarchy never commenced.
- 12. Under the Government of India Act, 1935, residuary subjects were:
 - A. Permanently vested in provinces
 - B. Vested in the Federal Court
 - C. Automatically concurrent
 - D. Allocated by the Governor-General

- ANSWER: D - The Governor-General decided the allocation of residuary subjects, reflecting the imperial controlling core.

MEMORY HOOK

Attempt first; read the answer only after fixing the chronology and institutional distinction.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Polity -> Historical Background -> Adaptive practice

HIGH

Solved MCQs 13-16

Prelims Indian
Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Original UPSC-style practice. Correct options rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D.

STATIC THEORY

- 13. Which statement best describes the constitutional position on 15 August 1947?
 - A. India became an independent Dominion with a sovereign legislature
 - B. India immediately became a republic
 - C. British Parliament retained legislative supremacy
 - D. The Constitution of India commenced

- ANSWER: A - India became an independent Dominion in 1947; republican status and the Constitution commenced on 26 January 1950.
- 14. The lapse of British paramountcy in 1947 meant that:
 - A. Every princely state automatically became an Indian province
 - B. British superior treaty authority over princely states ended, requiring accession and integration
 - C. Princely states became part of Pakistan
 - D. The Governor-General acquired permanent sovereignty over them

- ANSWER: B - Paramountcy did not automatically transfer to India. Accession, merger and political integration followed.
- 15. Which colonial institution has the clearest direct lineage into the Seventh Schedule?
 - A. Separate electorates
 - B. Board of Control
 - C. Three-fold legislative-list distribution under the 1935 Act
 - D. Court of Directors

- ANSWER: C - The 1935 distribution into Federal, Provincial and Concurrent Lists strongly influenced the present Union, State and Concurrent Lists.
- 16. Which thesis is most defensible regarding the Constitution and the 1935 Act?
 - A. The Constitution rejected every colonial institution
 - B. The Constitution merely copied the 1935 Act
 - C. The 1935 Act supplied popular sovereignty and Fundamental Rights
 - D. The Constitution retained significant administrative machinery but transformed sovereignty, rights, franchise and accountability

- ANSWER: D - This captures both institutional continuity and the democratic-republican break.

MEMORY HOOK

Attempt first; read the answer only after fixing the chronology and institutional distinction.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Polity -> Historical Background -> Adaptive practice

HIGH**Remedial MCQs****Prelims** Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Original UPSC-style practice. Correct options rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D.

STATIC THEORY

- R1. Which pairing is correct?

- A. 1909 - separate Muslim electorate
- B. 1919 - provincial autonomy
- C. 1935 - provincial dyarchy introduced
- D. 1947 - republic

- ANSWER: A - Use the anchor sequence: 1909 electorate, 1919 dyarchy, 1935 autonomy, 1947 Dominion independence, 1950 republic.

- R2. Who was the first Governor-General of India?

- A. Warren Hastings
- B. William Bentinck
- C. Lord Canning
- D. Lord Cornwallis

- ANSWER: B - Hastings was first Governor-General of Bengal; Bentinck was first Governor-General of India; Canning was first Viceroy.

- R3. Which statement about the 1935 Act is correct?

- A. Its federation operated from 1937
- B. Its central dyarchy operated during World War II
- C. It abolished provincial dyarchy
- D. It vested residuary powers in provinces

- ANSWER: C - The provincial-autonomy part operated; federation and central dyarchy did not.

- R4. Which statement distinguishes a reserved seat from a separate electorate?

- A. Both exclude general voters
- B. A reserved seat has no defined candidate category
- C. A separate electorate uses a common general roll
- D. A reserved seat can operate through a joint electorate in which all eligible constituency voters vote

- ANSWER: D - The Constitution retains reserved seats with a common electoral roll rather than colonial community-specific rolls.

MEMORY HOOK

Attempt first; read the answer only after fixing the chronology and institutional distinction.

MAINS ANGLE**STUDY LINK**

Polity -> Historical Background -> Adaptive practice

HIGH

Mains Practice - 10 marksGS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Examine how the Charter Acts transformed the East India Company from a commercial corporation into an administrative agency. Answer in 150 words.

ANSWER SPINE**1. Opening**

State the commerce-to-administration thesis.

V

2. 1813

Explain partial monopoly termination and wider access.

V

3. 1833

Show complete commercial exit and all-India centralisation.

V

4. 1853

Add legislative separation and competitive recruitment.

V

5. Judgement

Commercial liberalisation strengthened, rather than weakened, imperial state capacity.

STATIC THEORY

- The Charter Acts converted the Company's constitutional character in stages. The Charter Act, 1813 ended its monopoly over Indian trade while retaining tea and China trade, exposing the Company to commercial competition but preserving its governing role.
- The Charter Act, 1833 completed the commercial exit. The Company became a purely administrative body, the Governor-General of Bengal became the Governor-General of India, and legislative power was centralised. This change also supported legal codification through the Law Member and Law Commission.
- The Charter Act, 1853 separated legislative and executive work in the Governor-General's council and introduced the principle of open civil-service competition. Thus, the Company's commercial privileges declined while its bureaucratic and legislative machinery became more centralised and professional.
- The Acts therefore mark not a retreat of colonial power, but its conversion from mercantile privilege into an administrative state.

MAINS ANGLE

Model answers are frameworks for adaptation, not scripts for mechanical reproduction.

STUDY LINK

GS-II -> Constitutional development ->
Answer writing

HIGH

Mains Practice - 15 marksGS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Dyarchy under the Government of India Act, 1919 imposed responsibility without adequate authority. Analyse. Answer in 250 words.

ANSWER SPINE**1. Define**

Explain reserved and transferred subjects.

V

2. Institutional defect

Show dependence of transferred fields on reserved finance and bureaucracy.

V

3. Political defect

Note Governor's overriding authority and narrow franchise.

V

4. Learning

Connect authority, accountability and the 3F principle.

V

5. Conclusion

Explain why 1935 replaced dyarchy with provincial autonomy.

STATIC THEORY

- The Government of India Act, 1919 divided provincial subjects into reserved and transferred categories. Reserved subjects such as finance, police and land revenue remained with the Governor and his Executive Council, which was not responsible to the legislature. Transferred subjects such as education, public health, agriculture and local government were administered by Indian ministers answerable to provincial councils.
- This arrangement separated visible political responsibility from effective administrative power. Welfare departments required finance, personnel and coercive support controlled by the reserved side. Ministers could therefore be blamed for poor outcomes without possessing the resources necessary to deliver them.
- The Governor retained overriding and discretionary authority, while the restricted franchise weakened popular accountability. At the Centre, bicameralism expanded deliberation but did not make the Viceroy's executive responsible.
- Dyarchy demonstrates a general governance principle: responsibility must be matched by authority over functions, finances and functionaries. Its failure encouraged the Government of India Act, 1935 to abolish provincial dyarchy and introduce provincial autonomy, although gubernatorial safeguards still limited full responsibility.
- Thus, 1919 was constitutionally significant as an experiment in ministerial responsibility, but internally contradictory because the decisive instruments of government remained outside responsible control.

MAINS ANGLE

Model answers are frameworks for adaptation, not scripts for mechanical reproduction.

STUDY LINK

GS-II -> Constitutional development ->
Answer writing

HIGH

Mains Practice - 20 marksGS-II Indian
Polity**INTRO & ORIGIN**

The Constitution retained the administrative skeleton of the colonial state but replaced its imperial soul. Discuss with reference to constitutional developments between 1773 and 1947. Answer in 250 words.

ANSWER SPINE**1. Thesis**

Continuity of form; transformation of source, purpose and accountability.

V

2. Continuities

Lists, Governors, courts, services, audit, bicameral procedure and ordinances.

V

3. Breaks

Popular sovereignty, adult franchise, rights, republicanism and responsible government.

V

4. Critical layer

Acknowledge surviving centralising and coercive tendencies.

V

5. Judgement

Evaluate institutions by present constitutional purpose.

STATIC THEORY

- British statutes created much of the machinery later used by the Constitution. The Regulating and Charter Acts produced executive centralisation and a professional bureaucracy. The Councils Acts initiated legislative procedure and representation. The 1919 Act developed bicameralism and subject devolution, while the 1935 Act supplied the three-list structure, provincial autonomy, Governors, Public Service Commissions and the Federal Court.

- Yet constitutional continuity did not mean continuity of legitimacy. Colonial institutions were accountable ultimately to imperial authorities and operated through restricted franchise, executive supremacy and communal representation. The Constitution located sovereignty in the people, adopted universal adult suffrage, established a republic, guaranteed Fundamental Rights and made executives responsible to elected legislatures.

- The Federal Court evolved into a Supreme Court with stronger constitutional jurisdiction; civil services and commissions received constitutional safeguards; legislative lists became instruments of federal power-sharing rather than imperial allocation. Separate electorates were rejected in favour of a general electoral roll with reserved seats.

- Nevertheless, controversies involving Governors, ordinances, administrative secrecy, preventive powers and fiscal centralisation show that control-oriented habits may survive institutional transplantation.

- Therefore, the Constitution neither copied nor discarded the colonial state wholesale. It retained useful administrative forms while subjecting them to democratic sovereignty, rights, judicial review and constitutional morality.

MAINS ANGLE

Model answers are frameworks for adaptation, not scripts for mechanical reproduction.

STUDY LINK

GS-II -> Constitutional development ->
Answer writing